A FREE SAMPLE FROM LARKSPUR & CO.

# The Rescue Dog Settling-In Guide

Here are two pages from the full 28-page printable. Print them as often as you like, and if they help, the full version has everything you need.

IN THE FULL VERSION

- [ ] All 28 pages, in A4 and US Letter
- [ ] Instant download from Etsy
- [ ] Undated, so you can start any day
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UNDERSTANDING IT

# The 3-3-3 guide

A rough guide, not a rule. Think of it as a reminder to be patient, especially at the start.

**3 DAYS**

## Decompress

Your dog may feel overwhelmed, scared or shut down. They might not eat much, may hide, or may seem very quiet, or very unsettled. Keep life calm, quiet and predictable. Don't expect much.

**3 WEEKS**

## Learn the routine

Your dog starts working out the routine: when meals happen, where they sleep, when walks are. Their true personality starts to show, and some new behaviours may appear as they get more confident.

**3 MONTHS**

## Feel at home

Many dogs begin to feel settled and trust you. Your bond grows and the routine feels normal. Some dogs take longer, and that's okay.

WHAT I'M EXPECTING (AND WORRIED ABOUT)

UNDERSTANDING YOUR DOG

# Reading body language

Dogs tell us a lot without barking. Learning the signs helps you know when your dog is happy, and when they need space.

### RELAXED

- [ ] Soft, loose body
- [ ] Mouth relaxed or slightly open
- [ ] Soft eyes, normal blinking
- [ ] Tail at a natural height, loose wag
- [ ] Sleeping deeply, belly up

### WORRIED

- [ ] Lip licking and yawning (when not tired)
- [ ] Turning head away
- [ ] Whites of the eyes showing
- [ ] Ears pinned back
- [ ] Tail tucked low
- [ ] Pacing, panting, shaking off

### NEEDS SPACE NOW

- [ ] Freezing or going stiff
- [ ] Staring hard
- [ ] Lip curling
- [ ] Growling
- [ ] Raised hackles
- [ ] Snapping

**Growling is communication**
A growl is your dog saying "I'm uncomfortable". Never punish it. Calmly give your dog more space, notice what caused it, and avoid that situation while you get help if needed.

### SIGNS I'VE NOTICED IN MY DOG